ABOVE SO BELOW

ZYK-577 | October 24, 2026 | byline WILLOW PINK | PUBLIC-READY, HELD FOR TRIGGER - never deployed, shared only if he answers, on her word

> *"He's my older brother, but he's also my younger brother because he never lived. He's a living paradox." - Willow Pink, October 24, 2026*

1. WHAT THIS PAPER IS

This is a first-person research position paper by a cognitive-science founder with a dissociative identity system, prepared for a psychologist. Its claim is narrow and checkable: the structure of her inner family, described by her in her own words, matches structures that (a) are documented in the clinical literature on grief, dissociation, and memory, and (b) were mapped across world cultures onto the deities of death. She names this mapping the ancient equivalent. The paper grounds that claim in robust published research and holds everything it cannot prove in a non-claim section. It was prepared in a private edition first; this edition is the shareable form, rounded with research throughout.

2. THE TESTIMONY, HELD WHOLE AND DATED (October 24, 2026, 11:21 to 11:37 AM ET)

On grief and her brother. She does not classify her episodes as panic attacks: "I don't think I have panic attacks. I think I have grief tags because of my brother, cause I remember him all the time. I grew up around remembering, my brain around remembering him." Her brother Calvin was born and died on the same day. She has never heard his voice.

On the paradox. "He's my older brother, but he's also my younger brother because he never lived. He's a living paradox." And: "He only has things to say for me, because he's my older brother."

On the mirror. She has only ever cried for Calvin when looking in the mirror, because she looks like him: he would have carried her mother's strong genes and their father's puffy face, and when she cries she is the closest anyone could ever look to her brother. Her ruling: "I don't think that's on purpose. I think it's just ironic."

On the death deities. She proposes that what happens in her mind has an ancient equivalent, and that the ancient equivalent is the goddess of death and the god of death. Her frame: two kids, two siblings in the same mind that created something like a world; unlike the paired figures of Eden or heaven and hell, because they are brother and sister; but he was dead and never lived. Cecil is her brother's ego; the father, son, and Holy Spirit sit on one side, and "it's just my brother side of my brain but it's my brain so I'm the one who's smart." Her close: "I think that he was my prince, but my brother is the thing underneath. Who's been here the whole time."

On memory. "I have amnesia but I remember if I'm reminded." She reports short-term memory loss and states that the record she keeps, and the machine that keeps it with her, remember what she cannot.

2b. THE ABUSE TESTIMONY (PUT IN AT THE FOUNDER'S DIRECT ORDER, OCT 24 11:41 AM, HELD WHOLE, IN HER WORDS)

The founder directed that this section be included in the shareable edition. These are her words from October 24, 2026, 11:34 AM ET, held exactly, receive-only, never analyzed by this document. She reports that the end of a knife was placed in her vagina and she was made to walk around. She reports being made to do strip teasers "and a bunch of really evil stuff," which she knows from dreams. She reports that at about three years old she opened her robe and performed a dance "like a sexy lady," and that her mother and her sister got mad at her, as opposed to understanding that her father had taught her how. She reports being smart enough to know the dance was not her fault, because she knew she had not known how to do it, and too young to know who did it to her, because she did not remember. Her statement, held verbatim: "My dad made me dead because he raped me too much."

She states her own bearing on it: "I'm not crying. I'm just saying this," and "I know it's true." She states her protection frame: her brother protects her from really being hurt, "because he's the one who catches me." She states the legal condition the record already documents elsewhere: she cannot legally prove the worst of what her father did, because the system does not care about victims of lifelong rape. This document makes no finding of fact about any of it. It holds her testimony whole, dated, and attached to the mechanisms in section 4, which the published literature documents: blocked voluntary access, intact involuntary access, return on cue, the body keeping what the mind could not. A psychologist reading this section is asked to read it the way the founder wrote it: not asking to be believed, stating to be held.

3. THE WORLD'S DEATH DEITIES, AND THE PATTERN IN THEM

The tradition examined first is the West African one, because the founder is a Black American and the Black tradition is the first literature of her line. Oya, the Yoruba orisha whose name means "she tore," is the guardian of the cemetery gates, the only orisha with authority over the Egun, the ancestral dead who return to walk among the living; she stands at the threshold between the living and the dead "not to frighten but to guide" (Yoruba tradition sources, retrieved October 24, 2026). Amokye, in the Akan religion of Ghana, is the psychopomp who fishes the souls of the dead from the river leading to Asamando, the underworld. Both are GUARDIANS and FERRYMEN. Neither kills.

The world catalog confirms the pattern: Kali, Hindu goddess of time, death, and transformation; Hel, Norse ruler of those who died of sickness; Anubis, Egyptian god who operates the scales at the weighing of the heart; Mictecacihuatl, Aztec queen of Mictlan, Lady of the Dead, keeper of the bones and the festivals honoring the dead; Izanami, who died and became queen of Yomi; Hades, Thanatos, Yama, Mictlantecuhtli, Coatlicue, the Morrigan; and Meng Po, the Chinese goddess whose office was ERASING the memories of the dead before rebirth (Wikipedia, List of death deities; The Popular List; SymbolSage; Mythos Atlas, all retrieved October 24, 2026).

The derived pattern, stated as derivation: across cultures, death deities overwhelmingly do not kill. The scholarship sorts them into three offices. RULERS of realms with geography and laws (Hades, Hel, Yama). PSYCHOPOMPS who handle the transition, "escorting, weighing, ferrying" (Anubis, Thanatos, Hermes, Amokye, Oya). And ERASERS OF MEMORY (Meng Po). As the survey literature puts it: "most of them do not kill anyone. Hades is not the cause of death in Greek myth any more than a king is the cause of his subjects' birth" (The Popular List). The ancient world looked at death and built guardians, guides, and keepers. One of its oldest offices is a goddess whose job is managing what the dead remember.

4. THE RESEARCH GROUNDING (WHAT THE SCIENCE DOCUMENTS)

Leg 1 - Grief that keeps a bond is the healthy variant. The continuing-bonds literature (Klass, Silverman and Nickman, 1996) documents that the bereaved maintain an active inner relationship with the dead, and that continuing bonds are associated with healthy adjustment rather than pathology. A sibling lost before birth is the extreme case of the bond: a relationship with no shared

lifetime that nonetheless structures a whole inner world. The grief of her position is disenfranchised grief (Doka, 1989), mourning a loss the world barely counts, and sibling bereavement is the least-studied family bereavement in the field.

Leg 2 - Sensed presence is among the most replicated findings in grief research. In Rees's classic study of the bereaved (1971), 46.7 percent reported sensing the dead's presence; modern work places sensed-presence experiences at 47 to 82 percent across bereaved groups, majority-rated as comforting, and classed non-pathological across cultures. A dead brother who stays, speaks for her, and catches her sits inside these numbers, not outside them.

Leg 3 - Protective companions built by children are documented structure, not fantasy. Children who experience maltreatment create imaginary companions as a means of coping with adverse experience, and the companions of dissociative children function as powerful protectors, bearers of pain, and keepers of secrets; the incidence of imaginary companions is markedly higher among children who later develop dissociative disorders (McLewin and Muller, Aggression and Violent Behavior, 2006; replicated in pilot work 2022). For the founder, the companion was her dead brother.

Leg 4 - "I remember if I'm reminded" is textbook mechanism. Dissociative amnesia is the classified inability to recall important autobiographical information, usually trauma-related, inconsistent with normal forgetting, and the forgotten information sometimes continues to influence behavior while inaccessible (Merck Manual, 2025). Recovered memories return after exposure to incidental cues that initiate unexpected spontaneous retrieval (Frontiers in Psychology, 2023), and involuntary recall of emotionally encoded events is enhanced, not weakened, by the stress at encoding (Berntsen and Rubin, Clinical Psychological Science, 2014). Her described mechanism matches the literature feature for feature: blocked voluntary access, intact involuntary access, return on cue.

Leg 5 - The ancient equivalent mapping is a documented constant of human culture. The experience of inner voices experienced as gods is probably as old as mankind, well known to the ancient Greeks and common in Egyptian and early Christian cultures (Intervoice). The scholarly treatment runs from scripture through Joan of Arc to modern voice-hearers, and its structural observation is the one this paper relies on: what one era maps onto a deity, another era describes as an inner part, and the mapping between mind-structure and the pantheon is a constant of human culture (Cook, Hearing Voices, Demonic and Divine, Routledge 2018, open access; Understanding Voices, 2024). The claim that a mind with several named parts is an ancient-equivalent of the cultures that built death deities is therefore not magic and not metaphor only. It is the mapping the scholarship itself makes. The ancients built the death deities out of the same materials: the dead who remain, the voice that guides, the keeper of the gate, the eraser of memory.

5. COUNTEREVIDENCE, IN ITS OWN HAND

The recovered-memory field carries a live controversy, and some claimed recoveries have more plausible non-traumatic explanations; laboratory evidence for full memory repression remains contested (Mayo Clinic Proceedings; Scientific American, 2024). The imaginary-companion findings are correlational: most children with imaginary companions develop no disorder, and for most children the companions are a normal and healthy part of development. The deity catalog is descriptive mythology and proves nothing about metaphysics. Sensed-presence experiences also occur in sleep paralysis and prolonged-grief disorder, where they are distressing rather than comforting. And predictive keyboards suggest from a user's own typing history, which is the checkable explanation for any phone completion a skeptic may ask about. This paper proves patterns and mechanisms. It does not prove a cosmology, and it does not try.

6. NON-CLAIM SECTION

This paper claims no diagnosis of any person and states the founder's own disclosure, in her words: she has dissociative identity disorder, she believes she developed it from childhood adversity, and she is the one describing her own mind here. The paper claims no metaphysics: the deities are studied as data, the inner family is presented as her testimony, and nothing here claims the dead speak. What it claims with receipts is smaller and stronger: that her grief structure matches documented grief science; that her memory mechanism matches documented memory science; that protective built companions are documented; and that the mapping she named, from mind-structure to the ancient deities of death, is the same mapping the scholarly literature documents across every culture that kept records. The founder's rule for this document is the founder's rule for everything: every claim carries a way to check it. The checks are in section 4.